

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1250

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Tom Midyett for his service on the Tennessee Forestry Commission.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly recognize those exemplary professionals who work with purpose and commitment to improve the quality of life of the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, Tom Midyett is one such individual, who has dedicated ten years to serving as a member of the Tennessee Forestry Commission; and

WHEREAS, appointed by Governor Bill Lee, Mr. Midyett represented the pulp and paper industry on the State Forestry Commission for two consecutive five-year terms; and

WHEREAS, through his skillful leadership and keen guidance, Mr. Midyett has positioned the Tennessee Division of Forestry for continued success in fire suppression, landowner support, seedling production at the East Tennessee Nursery, and effective management of sixteen State forests; and

WHEREAS, as Chairman of the Tennessee Forestry Commission, Tom Midyett prioritized equipping staff with safe, modern resources; his collaborative approach secured additional funding for the Division of Forestry, supported staff development, and ensured adequate staffing to meet the needs of Tennessee citizens in sustaining and expanding the State's forest resources; and

WHEREAS, he also recognized the importance of urban forests throughout Tennessee's cities, which provide stable watersheds and public enjoyment; and

WHEREAS, Tom Midyett's vision during his tenure on the Forestry Commission has positively influenced Tennessee's 13.8 million acres of forestland, eighty-three percent of which are owned by private, non-industrial landowners; and

WHEREAS, over the past decade, Tennessee's forest industry has contributed more than \$29 billion annually to the State's economy; Mr. Midyett's leadership has paved the way for the Division of Forestry to expand its services and reach communities across the State; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee is most fortunate to have such a passionate champion of State forests as Mr. Midyett, and it is fitting that we pause to recognize his contributions; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Tom Midyett for his ten years of devoted service as a member of the Tennessee Forestry Commission, extending to him our best wishes for much continued success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.